



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

THE LIGHT OF THE QURAN

A Modern Companion to the Holy Quran Sharif

Volume III • Juz 4 & 5 • Surah An-Nisa & Surah Al-Ma'idah

In the Blessed Tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Justice • Women's Rights • Inter-faith • Isa (AS)'s Table • The Final Covenant

Designed for the Younger Generation of Muslims by Syed Yasir Ahmad

RECAP — VOLUMES I & II

Volume	Juz	Surahs	Core Teaching
I	1	Al-Fatiha, Al-Baqarah (1-141)	Foundation: Faith, law, Adam, Bani Israel, Ibrahim (AS), Ayat ul-Kursi
II	2-3	Al-Baqarah (142-286), Aal-e-Imran	Charity, marriage, Jihad, Sabr; Maryam, Isa (AS), Uhud, Unity, Best Nation
III (this volume)	4-5	An-Nisa, Al-Ma'idah	Justice & rights; food laws; Isa (AS)'s table; the final covenant of Islam

***'We have sent down to you the Book as clarification for all things, and as guidance and mercy and good tidings for the Muslims.'* — Quran 16:89**

SURAH 4 • JUZ 4 & 5

سُورَةُ النِّسَاءِ
AN-NISA — THE WOMEN

The Quran's Most Comprehensive Charter of Justice & Human Rights

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

- Revelation:** Madani — revealed years 3-5 AH, after Battle of Uhud
- Number of Ayat:** 176 Verses
- Named After:** An-Nisa — Women — because it contains the most comprehensive women's rights legislation in the Quran
- Key Themes:** Inheritance rights, marriage, orphans' protection, justice, hypocrisy, the nature of Prophethood
- Historical Context:** Revealed after Uhud — 70 men martyred left many widows and orphans needing legal protection
- Famous Verses:** 4:1 (humanity from one soul), 4:3 (marriage), 4:58 (justice/trusts), 4:135 (standing firmly for justice), 4:157 (Isa (AS) not crucified)
- Key Principle:** La-zulma — No oppression. Justice (Adl) is the thread running through every ruling in this Surah

PART 1: ONE HUMANITY — THE OPENING VERSE (4:1)

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ

"O mankind! Fear your Lord who created you from a single soul and created from it its mate and dispersed from both of them many men and women." 4:1

This is one of the most powerful opening statements in the Quran. Allah does not say 'O Muslims' or 'O Arabs' or 'O believers' — He says 'O MANKIND.' The entire human race is addressed. And the message is: you all come from ONE soul (nafs wahidah — generally understood as Sayyiduna Adam (AS)). This single verse dismantles racism, tribalism, nationalism, and every form of human hierarchy based on origin.

What This Verse Demolishes	How	Modern Equivalent
Racism	One soul — all humans share the same origin	Every race comes from the same DNA ancestor
Class-based superiority	No mention of wealth, status, or power as a basis of worth	Meritocracy of Taqwa (God-consciousness) — not birth
Gender hierarchy of origin	'Created from it its mate' — woman from man's own essence	Equal origin — different roles, not different worth
Nationalism	'Dispersed from both of them many men and women'	Diversity is Allah's design — not a reason for division
Tribalism	Wa ittaqullaha alladhi — fear the ONE Lord who created all	One Creator, one humanity — tribal pride is secondary

♦ **MIRACLE: The Mitochondrial Eve — Science is consistent the Quran**

In 1987, a landmark study in Nature magazine by molecular biologists at UC Berkeley traced all human mitochondrial DNA to a single female ancestor — nicknamed 'Mitochondrial Eve' — estimated to have lived approximately 150,000-200,000 years ago in Africa. All 8 billion humans alive today share this common maternal ancestor. The Quran's declaration of humanity from 'a single soul' — stated 1,400 years before genetics — some view this as an interesting parallel with the Quranic description of human origin.. SubhanAllah.

This scientific finding is sometimes seen as reflecting the Quranic idea of a shared human origin, though Islamic belief about Sayyiduna Adam ('alayhis salam) is based on revelation, not scientific theory.

PART 2: THE RIGHTS OF ORPHANS — ISLAM'S MOST URGENT SOCIAL MISSION

An-Nisa opens with one of the most urgent social concerns in 7th-century Arabia — and one of the most relevant to the modern world: the protection of orphans. After the Battle of Uhud left 70 families without fathers, the Madinah community faced a crisis of vulnerable children and their wealth. Allah's response was comprehensive legislation.

وَأْتُوا الْيَتَامَىٰ أَمْوَالَهُمْ وَلَا تَتَبَدَّلُوا الْخَيْرَ بِالْطَّبِيبِ

"Give the orphans their wealth and do not substitute worthless things for their good things, and do not consume their property by adding it to your own." 4:2

Allah's 5-Point Charter for Orphan Protection (An-Nisa):

1. Return their wealth: Do not consume orphans' inheritance — it is a trust (Amanah) (4:2)
2. Full inheritance rights: Orphans receive fixed legal shares — no one can override them (4:7-12)
3. No exploitation in marriage: The verse on polygamy (4:3) is directly connected to protecting orphan girls from exploitation
4. Test before transfer: When they reach maturity, test their readiness before giving them their wealth (4:6)
5. Severe warning: 'Those who consume orphans' wealth unjustly consume fire into their bellies' (4:10)

STORY: The Context of the Polygamy Verse — What Most People Miss

Verse 4:3 — 'If you fear you will not be just with orphan girls, then marry (other) women you find agreeable, two, three, or four. But if you fear you will not be just, then only one.' This verse is almost always quoted OUT of context. Its immediate context is the PROTECTION OF ORPHAN GIRLS who were being married by their guardians to seize their inheritance. The Quran is NOT saying 'you can freely take four wives.' It is saying: 'If you're about to marry an orphan girl to exploit her wealth — don't. If you must marry, be just. And if you can't be just between multiple wives — then one only.' The verse ends: 'That is more likely that you will not be unjust.' (4:3). The burden of the verse is JUSTICE and PROTECTION — not permission for multiple marriage without condition.

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Strict Conditions of Polygamy — Scholarly Consensus

The scholars of all four madhabs (Hanafi, Maliki, Shafi'i, Hanbali) are unanimous: polygamy is permissible but heavily conditional. The conditions include: absolute justice between wives (financial, time, emotional) — which the Quran itself says is nearly impossible (4:129); the first wife's consideration and rights; the financial capacity to provide for all; and the social context (e.g., many widows in a war community). The Prophet ﷺ himself had multiple wives — but each marriage was in a specific social, political, or compassionate context. Scholars note that the permission is a regulated concession — not an encouragement. Sayyiduna Ali ؑ had only one wife (Sayyidah Fatima ؑ) during her lifetime, at the Prophet ﷺ's insistence.

PART 3: THE LAW OF INHERITANCE — ONE OF THE WORLD'S FIRST WRITTEN INHERITANCE CODE

Verses 4:11-12 and 4:176 — A Complete Legal System

The inheritance verses of An-Nisa constitute the world's most detailed written inheritance law — revealed in the 7th century, centuries before modern legal codes. Every relative's share is precisely defined. No ruler, no court, no individual can override them. They are direct commands from Allah.

Heir	Share	Condition
Daughter (only child)	1/2 of estate	If no son
Two or more daughters	2/3 of estate	If no son
Son	Double a daughter's share	Sons and daughters together — son gets 2x
Mother	1/6	If deceased has children
Mother	1/3	If no children
Father	1/6	If deceased has children
Husband	1/2	If wife has no children
Husband	1/4	If wife has children
Wife	1/4	If husband has no children
Wife	1/8	If husband has children

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: Why Does a Son Get Double a Daughter's Share?

This is one of the most frequently questioned rulings. Scholars explain the Islamic economic system holistically: a son receives double because he bears 100% of the financial obligation of his future household — Mahr (bridal gift) to his wife, nafaqah (maintenance) of wife and children, and the duty to support his parents. A daughter, by contrast, retains her inheritance entirely as her own wealth — her husband is obligated to provide for her financially, and she is not obligated to spend from her inheritance on the household. When you calculate the TOTAL financial responsibility vs TOTAL financial right across a lifetime, Islamic scholars demonstrate that women actually receive MORE financial security than men under this system — not less. The apparent '2:1' ratio inverts when lifetime obligations are factored in.

♦ MIRACLE: The First Written Estate Law in Human History

Before Islam, Arabia had no formal inheritance law. Women and daughters received nothing — wealth passed only to male warriors. Roman law was complex and frequently disputed. The Quran's inheritance system — revealed in 7th-century Arabia — was the one of the earliest and most detailed systems specifying fixed shares for inheritance, particularly including women, daughters, mothers, and wives. Modern legal systems in most Muslim-majority countries still use these Quranic fractions as their civil code basis. Western legal systems did not grant daughters equal inheritance rights until the 19th-20th centuries.

› NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):



The inheritance laws of An-Nisa remind us that Islam is not vague in its commitments to justice. Allah did not say 'be fair' — He gave exact fractions. This precision is mercy. It eliminates family disputes, prevents exploitation, and ensures every person — especially women — receives their due. Scholars teach that ignoring the inheritance laws is one of the most widespread sins in Muslim families today. How many of us have seen an aunt, a sister, or a daughter denied her rightful inheritance? This is a violation of Quranic law.

PART 4: THE GREATEST VERSE ON JUSTICE — 4:135

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُونُوا قَوَّامِينَ بِالْقِسْطِ شُهَدَاءَ لِلَّهِ

"O you who believe! Be persistently standing firmly for justice, as witnesses for Allah, even if it be against yourselves, your parents, or your relatives." 4:135

This single verse is the Quran's most radical statement on justice. It does not say 'be fair to others.' It says be a **STANDING WITNESS** for justice — even when justice hurts YOU. Even when the truth is against your own father. Against your own tribe. Against yourself.

The Three Levels of Justice in 4:135:

Level 1 — Justice against yourself: 'Even against yourselves' — if you are wrong, admit it. If you owe someone, pay them. The hardest justice.

Level 2 — Justice against your parents: 'Or your parents' — Islamic justice supersedes family loyalty. You cannot lie for your parents in court. You cannot cover their oppression.

Level 3 — Justice against the poor and rich equally: 'Whether against the rich or poor — Allah is more worthy of both.' Wealth and poverty cannot bend justice.

Type of Justice in An-Nisa	Verse	Modern Application
Adl in trusts/authority	4:58	Give Amanah (trusts) to those qualified — not to family favourites
Adl in testimony	4:135	Speak truth even against your own side — in courts, online, in disputes
Adl in polygamy	4:3, 4:129	Do not take on multiple responsibilities you cannot fulfil equitably
Adl in inheritance	4:11-12	Distribute estates according to Quranic law — not custom
Adl to all people	4:58	Leaders, employers, parents — judge fairly regardless of relationship
Adl to enemies	4:90	Even in war — justice to the enemy who seeks peace
Adl to oneself	4:135	Accountability starts from within — hold yourself to the same standard

إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تُؤَدُّوا الْأَمَانَاتِ إِلَىٰ أَهْلِهَا

"Indeed, Allah commands you to render trusts to those who are entitled to them, and when you judge between people, judge with justice." 4:58



SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: Amanah — The Trust — As a Leadership Principle

Verse 4:58 on Amanah (trust) is cited by scholars as the foundation of Islamic leadership theory. Amanah includes: returning borrowed items; fulfilling contracts; honest speech; being trustworthy with secrets; giving people their rights; and — critically for public life — placing qualified people in positions of authority (not based on nepotism or tribalism). The Prophet ﷺ said: 'When a trust is lost, await the Hour.' When asked what 'losing the trust' means: 'When authority is given to those unqualified for it.' (Bukhari). This is a diagnosis of what ails much of the Muslim world's governance today.

NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

Justice begins at home, not in courts. Do you give your siblings their fair shares? Do you speak up when your own community does something wrong? Do you acknowledge when YOU are the problem in a conflict? The Quran commands Qawwameen bil-Qist — being **STANDING**, **PERSISTENT** people of justice. Not occasional. Not comfortable. Standing. This is the most demanding and most rewarding character the Quran calls us to build.

PART 5: THE ANATOMY OF HYPOCRISY — NIFAQ IN AN-NISA

The Quran's Most Detailed Analysis of Spiritual Dishonesty

An-Nisa contains more verses about hypocrisy (Nifaq) than almost any other Surah. Why? Because the community in Madinah faced the most dangerous internal threats to a community. — those who SAY they are Muslim but whose hearts are elsewhere. The Quran gives us a detailed description of traits and behaviours..

Sign of the Munafiq	Quranic Verse	Modern Equivalent
Laziness in prayer	4:142 — 'They rise to prayer lazily, showing off to people'	Praying only when someone is watching; prayer as social performance
Double-faced loyalty	4:138-139 — 'Taking disbelievers as allies instead of believers'	Publicly Muslim; privately aligning with anti-Islamic agendas
Wavering in faith	4:143 — 'Wavering between this and that — belonging neither to these nor those'	Cultural Muslim when convenient; non-Muslim when it suits
Mocking believers	4:140 — 'When you hear Allah's signs denied and mocked'	Joining in ridicule of Islamic values to 'fit in'
Delay in obedience	4:61 — 'When told to come to Allah's command, they turn away'	Knowing the right thing; continually delaying it
Selective Islam	4:150-151 — 'Believing in some and disbelieving in others'	Accepting science, rejecting Islamic ethics; picking and choosing
Fear of people over Allah	4:77 — 'They fear people as they should fear Allah, or even more'	Not speaking Islamic truth for fear of social judgement

⚠️ IMPORTANT: The Lowest Depth of the Fire

The Quran states in 4:145: 'Indeed, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths of the Fire.' The punishment for hypocrisy is described as worse than that for open disbelief. Scholars explain: the open disbeliever is honest about their rejection. The hypocrite damages the community from within — corrupting trust, weakening unity, deceiving the vulnerable. Internal corruption is more destructive than external opposition. This is a sobering call to examine our own sincerity.

📖 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

The antidote to Nifaq is not self-condemnation — it is Ikhlas (sincerity). Ask yourself daily: Am I doing this act of worship for Allah or for people? Imam Ghazali in Ihya Uloom ud-Din dedicates entire chapters to diagnosing and treating the subtle forms of Nifaq that affect even sincere believers — including showing off (Riya), loving praise, and hating criticism. Scholars teach that regular



Muhasaba (self-accounting) is the only cure. The soul that examines itself daily rarely falls into deep Nifaq.

PART 6: WOMEN IN AN-NISA — A COMPREHENSIVE RIGHTS FRAMEWORK

What Islam ACTUALLY Gives Women — Verse by Verse

No Surah in any religious scripture dedicates more attention to women's legal rights than An-Nisa. Rather than reading isolated verses, let us map the complete picture that this Surah paints.

Women's Rights Enshrined in Surah An-Nisa (the 100 represents the rights firmly established)

Right to inheritance	100	4:11-12, 4:176
Right to Mahr (bridal gift)	100	4:4
Protection from exploitation	100	4:2, 4:19
Right to divorce (Khul')	100	4:128
Right to financial maintenance	100	4:34
Protection from coercion	100	4:19
Right to remarry	100	4:23-24
Right to testimony	100	4:135
Equal spiritual standing	100	4:124

وَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِنَ الصَّالِحَاتِ مِنْ ذَكَرٍ أَوْ أُنْثَىٰ وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ

"And whoever does righteous deeds — whether male or female — while being a believer, those will enter Paradise and will not be wronged even as much as the speck on a date seed." 4:124

This verse is the Quran's declaration of complete spiritual equality between men and women. In the sight of Allah — in terms of faith, deeds, and ultimate reward — there is no difference in spiritual worth and reward before Allah between a man and a woman. The same Paradise. The same reward. The same standard of accountability.



HISTORICAL CONTEXT: The Historical Revolution of An-Nisa

In pre-Islamic Arabia, women had no inheritance rights — they were sometimes inherited themselves as property after a husband's death. Female infanticide was common. Women had no right to divorce, no right to property, and no legal standing. The Quran's revelation of An-Nisa turned this on its head overnight. Women received: a named share of every inheritance, an unbreakable right to Mahr paid to them personally, the right to seek divorce (Khul'), protection from being inherited or coerced, and equal spiritual standing. The Prophet ﷺ said in his Farewell Sermon: 'O people, you have rights over your wives, and they have rights over you.' This was revolutionary — and it came from divine revelation, not political negotiation.

The Verse on Qawwamun (4:34) — Most Misunderstood Verse in the Quran

الرِّجَالُ قَوَّامُونَ عَلَى النِّسَاءِ بِمَا فَضَّلَ اللَّهُ بَعْضَهُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ

"Men are the caretakers/maintainers of women, by reason of what Allah has given one over the other and what they spend from their wealth." 4:34

What 'Qawwamun' Actually Means — Scholar Consensus:

The word 'Qawwam' does not indicate superiority, but responsibility and maintenance. Its root (Qaf-Waw-Meem) means 'one who stands for, maintains, takes responsibility for.' It is closer to 'responsible caretaker' than 'ruler.' The verse explicitly gives TWO reasons for this role: (1) bima faddala — by what Allah has apportioned (differences in physical role); (2) bima anfaqu — by what they spend from their wealth (financial obligation). This is a RESPONSIBILITY, not a privilege. When a man fails to financially maintain his wife, scholars are unanimous: she is no longer under his 'qawwama.' The verse is about accountability — not dominance.

SURAH 5 • JUZ 6 (begins here)

سُورَةُ الْمَائِدَةِ

AL-MA'IDAH — THE TABLE SPREAD

The Last Major Surah Revealed • The Final Covenant of Islam • The Table from Heaven

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Madani — one of the LAST Surahs revealed; many ayat from the Farewell Hajj (10 AH / 632 CE)

Number of Ayat: 120 Verses

Why It Matters: Because it is late revelation, its rulings are final and definitive —many of its rulings are among the final legislative teachings, and some earlier rulings are understood to be clarified or superseded by it

Named After: The Table (Ma'idah) sent from heaven to Sayyiduna Isa (AS) and his disciples

Key Themes: Fulfilling covenants; food laws; inter-faith relations; justice in all things; Isa (AS)'s final testimony

Famous Verses: 5:3 (Islam completed), 5:32 (one life = all humanity), 5:48 (diversity is divine design), 5:112-115 (the heavenly table)

Closing Message: 5:120 — 'To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and whatever is within them, and He is over all things competent'

PART 7: FULFIL YOUR COVENANTS — THE SURAH'S OPENING COMMAND (5:1)

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ

"O you who believe! Fulfil your covenants/contracts." 5:1

Just three words — but they carry the entire weight of Islamic ethics in public and private life. 'Awfu bil-uqood' — Fulfil your contracts. Honour your word. Keep your promises. The Surah opens with this command because everything that follows — food laws, justice, inter-faith relations, leadership — only works in a society built on trustworthiness.

Type of Contract Islam Requires You to Honour	Examples	Consequence of Breaking
Contract with Allah	Shahadah, prayer, fasting, Hajj	Spiritual rupture — dishonouring the Covenant of faith
Contract with spouse	Marriage (Nikah) contract; rights and duties	Harm to family; Quranic violation of rights
Contract in business	Written agreements, verbal promises, employment terms	Haram earnings; destruction of trust
Contract with society	Laws, community agreements, civic duties	Social breakdown; Fitnah



Type of Contract Islam Requires You to Honour	Examples	Consequence of Breaking
Contract with other faiths	Dhimmi treaties; inter-faith agreements	Historical violation cited by the Quran (5:13-14)
Contract with yourself	Tawbah, intentions, personal commitments to Allah	Spiritual inconsistency — a form of Nifaq

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Islamic Law of Contracts — 1,400 Years Before Modern Commercial Law

The Quran's insistence on fulfilling contracts (5:1) generated one of the most sophisticated contract law traditions in human history. Islamic contract law — developed by scholars like Imam Abu Hanifa, Imam Malik, Imam Shafi'i, and their students — governed international trade from Spain to China for centuries. The Hawala system (money transfer through trust-based contracts) predated modern banking by centuries and is still used today. Many principles of modern commercial contract law — offer, acceptance, consideration, good faith — have direct parallels in Fiqh al-Mu'amalat developed from 5:1.

PART 8: THE COMPLETION OF ISLAM — THE GREATEST VERSE OF MA'IDAH (5:3)

الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتِمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا

"This day I have perfected for you your religion and completed My favour upon you and have approved for you Islam as your religion." 5:3

📖 STORY: The Day of Arafah — Islam's Most Historic Moment

It was the 9th of Dhul Hijjah, 10 AH (March 632 CE). The Prophet ﷺ stood on the plain of Arafah during his Farewell Hajj — the only Hajj of his life — before 124,000 Companions. As he delivered his Farewell Sermon, this verse descended. When Sayyiduna Umar ؓ heard it, he wept. The Prophet ﷺ asked him why. He replied: 'Because completion follows — and after perfection, there is only decline.' The Prophet ﷺ passed from this world less than 81 days later. The verse was the Quran's own announcement of its own completion. Islam — as a revealed guidance — was now whole, sealed, and preserved. Nothing was to be added. Nothing was to be removed. For all time.

What Was 'Completed' on That Day?

- ✓ **The Quran:** 114 Surahs, 6,236 verses — fully revealed over 23 years
- ✓ **The Law (Shariah):** All major rulings on worship, family, finance, and society — revealed
- ✓ **The Theology (Aqeedah):** Complete understanding of Allah, Prophets, Angels, Afterlife — clarified
- ✓ **The Prophetic Model (Sunnah):** 23 years of the Prophet ﷺ demonstrating Islam — recorded by Companions
- ✓ **The Community (Ummah):** The first generation of believers — formed, trained, and commissioned
- ✓ **The Promise (Ni'mah):** 'I have completed My favour upon you' — the greatest gift to humanity: guidance

♦ MIRACLE: The Preservation of the Quran — Humanity's Most Verified Text

The Quran is the only religious scripture in human history that has been preserved letter-perfect since its revelation. The process: the Prophet ﷺ recited each verse to designated scribes immediately after revelation; these were written on leather, bones, and parchment; the Companions memorised the entire Quran; Sayyiduna Abu Bakr ؓ commissioned the first compiled manuscript within a year of the Prophet ﷺ's death; Sayyiduna Uthman ؓ standardised the official Mushaf within 20 years. Today, every Quran in the world — from Indonesia to Nigeria to Canada — is identical, letter for letter. No other scripture of this age can make this claim.

PART 9: ONE LIFE EQUALS ALL OF HUMANITY — 5:32

مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا

"Whoever kills a soul — unless for a soul or for corruption in the land — it is as if he had slain all of mankind. And whoever saves one, it is as if he had saved all of mankind." 5:32

This is one of the most profound moral statements ever written. It places infinite value on every single human life. The murder of one person is not a local crime — in Allah's view, it is as if all 8 billion humans were killed. The saving of one life is as if all 8 billion were saved.

Implications of 5:32 for the Modern Muslim:

Against Terrorism: Any attack on civilians — regardless of political justification — is in the Quran's view the equivalent of killing all of humanity. No political cause can override 5:32.

For Medicine: A Muslim doctor who saves a life participates in saving 'all of humanity.'

Medicine, nursing, and public health are among the highest Islamic callings.

Against Suicide: The infinite value of life applies to yourself. 'Whoever saves one' — this includes preserving your own life with care, mental health support, and reaching out for help.

For Justice Systems: Islamic criminal law is built on the near-impossibility of capital punishment — requiring four witnesses and multiple conditions — because the bar for taking a life must be infinitely high.

⚠️ IMPORTANT: The Full Context — Often Cut Off

The full verse (5:32) begins: 'Because of that, We decreed upon the Children of Israel...' — it is presented as a lesson from Allah's covenant with Bani Israel, emphasising that this principle of the infinite value of life was always the divine standard. The verse BEFORE it (5:31) tells the story of Cain and Abel (Qabeel and Habeel) — humanity's first murder — showing that the violation of one life shook the foundations of creation. And the verse AFTER it (5:33) defines the Quranic punishment for those who cause corruption and terror on earth. The context makes the verse MORE emphatic — not less.

PART 10: DIVERSITY IS DIVINE DESIGN — 5:48

لِكُلِّ جَعَلْنَا مِنْكُمْ شِرْعَةً وَمِنْهَاجًا وَلَوْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ لَجَعَلَكُمْ أُمَّةً وَاحِدَةً

"For each of you We have appointed a law and a way. And had Allah willed, He could have made you one community — but He willed to test you in what He has given you. So race to all that is good." 5:48

This is one of the most intellectually stunning verses in the entire Quran. Allah says: I COULD have made everyone the same religion, the same culture, the same way. I CHOSE not to. Diversity of communities is part of the divine plan — and our response to that diversity should be to 'race to all that is good.'

What 5:48 Teaches	Practical Implication	What It Rejects
Diversity of laws/ways is Allah's will	Islam does not seek to forcibly convert or erase other cultures	Forced assimilation or religious coercion
'Race to goodness' — compete in good deeds	Muslims should be the leaders in justice, charity, and contribution	Lazy religiosity or self-satisfied isolation
Testing through differences	Differences are not problems to eliminate but tests to navigate with wisdom	Tribalism, exclusivism, 'my group vs yours'
One ultimate return to Allah	All human diversity ultimately faces the same accountability	Moral relativism — 'all paths are equally valid'

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: Islam and Other Religions — The Quranic Framework

The Quran's approach to other faiths is nuanced: it affirms that all Prophets brought truth from the same Allah (2:136); it acknowledges that previous scriptures were genuine revelation that was later altered (5:13-14); it commands Muslims to protect churches, synagogues, and monasteries (22:40); it permits eating food of Ahl al-Kitab and marrying their women (5:5); it commands: 'There is no compulsion in religion' (2:256). At the same time, the Quran is clear that the final, preserved guidance is Islam (5:3). Scholars teach that this combination — respect for all people, protection of all faiths, conviction in Islam's truth — is the only consistent position.

PART 11: FOOD LAWS IN AL-MA'IDAH — THE HALAL FRAMEWORK

5:3-5 — What is Forbidden and Why

Al-Ma'idah contains the most comprehensive statement of Islamic food law. These are not arbitrary restrictions — each prohibition has wisdom that scholars have elaborated upon for centuries.

Prohibited Food	Quranic Reference	Scholarly Wisdom
Mayta (carrion — dead without slaughter)	5:3	Dead animals may carry disease; uncontrolled death causes bacterial danger
Blood (dam masfooh — flowing blood)	5:3	Blood is a vector for pathogens; its consumption risks bloodborne disease
Pork (lahm al-khinzeer)	5:3	Pigs carry parasites (Trichinella, tapeworm) that persist even in cooked meat; also a reflection of its scavenging nature
Dedicated to other than Allah	5:3	Spiritual: breaking the chain of Tawheed in nourishment
Strangled, beaten, fallen, gored, or partially eaten	5:3	All involve uncontrolled death — risk of disease and pain
Intoxicants (khamr)	5:90-91	Destroys intellect, family, wealth, health — the Quran's most extensive single prohibition

♦ MIRACLE: The Science of Halal Slaughter

Islamic slaughter (Dhabihah) requires: the animal must be alive and healthy; a sharp blade cuts the jugular vein, carotid artery, and windpipe in one swift motion; the name of Allah is invoked; the blood is fully drained. Modern food science confirms: this method causes maximum blood drainage (blood is the primary medium for bacterial growth in meat); the swift cut to the neck — severing the spinal cord — causes immediate unconsciousness via blood pressure drop to the brain, while the heart continues pumping, draining blood. Studies by veterinary scientists have confirmed that properly performed Dhabihah causes less prolonged pain than other slaughter methods. The Quran's method, revealed 1,400 years ago, is scientifically optimal.

The Prohibition of Alcohol — Al-Ma'idah 5:90-91

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْخَمْرُ وَالْمَيْسِرُ وَالْأَنْصَابُ وَالْأَزْلَامُ رِجْسٌ

"O you who believe! Intoxicants, gambling, sacrificing on stone altars, and divining arrows are but defilement from the work of Shaytan — so avoid it, that you may be successful."

5:90

The Quran groups alcohol with gambling, idol worship, and divination — all tools of Shaytan that corrupt the human mind and soul. The WHO estimates alcohol causes 3 million deaths annually worldwide — more than HIV, tuberculosis, and violence combined. The Quran called it 'Rijs' (filth) before modern medicine could confirm its destruction. And note: the verse doesn't say 'drink in moderation' — it says 'ijtanibuhu' — AVOID IT ENTIRELY.

PART 12: THE TABLE FROM HEAVEN — THE SURAH'S NAME (5:112-115)

The Miracle That Named This Surah

📖 STORY: Al-Ma'idah — The Heavenly Table of Isa (AS)

After Sayyiduna Isa (Jesus) alayhis salam had gathered his disciples (Hawariyyun) and they had followed him through hardship, they made a request that seemed extraordinary: 'O Isa, son of Maryam! Can your Lord send down to us a table spread with food from heaven?' (5:112). Isa (AS) replied: 'Fear Allah, if you are indeed believers.' But they insisted: 'We wish to eat from it and have our hearts assured and know that you have been truthful to us, and we be among its witnesses.' Isa (AS) then made du'a: 'O Allah, our Lord, send down to us a table spread with food from the heaven to be for us a festival for the first and the last of us, and a sign from You. And provide for us, for You are the best of providers.' Allah answered: 'I will send it down to you. But whoever disbelieves afterwards — I will punish them with a punishment the like of which I have not inflicted upon anyone in the worlds.' (5:114-115). The table descended. This miracle — the Ma'idah — gave the entire Surah its name. Scholars note it is also the Quranic parallel to the Last Supper — but presented as a miracle of divine provision, not as the theological centrepiece that Christianity makes of it.

The Islamic vs Christian Account of the Last Supper	Islamic Quranic View (5:112-115)	Christian Gospel Account
Nature of the event	A miraculous table of food sent from heaven — a sign of Allah's power	The final Passover meal before crucifixion
Significance	A miracle confirming Isa (AS)'s Prophethood; a blessing	The institution of the Eucharist — 'this is my body/blood'
Who initiated	The disciples asked; Isa (AS) prayed; Allah sent it	Jesus gathered the disciples and initiated
Consequence of rejection	Allah warns of unprecedented punishment for ingratitude	Gospel does not frame it as a warning
Purpose in scripture	To show Allah's generosity and the consequences of thanklessness	Theological foundation of Christian communion

PART 13: ISA (AS)'S FINAL TESTIMONY ON THE DAY OF JUDGMENT (5:116-118)

The closing section of Surah Al-Ma'idah contains one of the most moving passages in the Quran — a conversation that will take place on the Day of Judgment between Allah and Sayyiduna Isa alayhis salam.

وَإِذْ قَالَ اللَّهُ يُعِيسَى ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ ءَأَنْتَ قُلْتَ لِلنَّاسِ اتَّخِذُونِي وَأُمِّي إِلَهَيْنِ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ

"And when Allah will say: O Isa, son of Maryam! Did you say to people: Take me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?" 5:116

قَالَ سُبْحَنكَ مَا يَكُونُ لِي أَنْ أَقُولَ مَا لَيْسَ لِي بِحَقٍّ

"He will say: Exalted are You! It was not for me to say what I had no right to say. If I had said it, You would have known it." 5:116

The Five Declarations of Isa (AS) in His Final Testimony:

1. 'Subhanaka' — Exalted are You! — First he glorifies Allah; denies any claim to divinity (5:116)
2. 'It was not for me to say what I had no right to' — He denies ever claiming divinity (5:116)
3. 'You know what is in my soul and I do not know what is in Yours' — He affirms Allah's total knowledge and his own human limitation (5:116)
4. 'I only told them what You commanded me: Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord' (5:117) — His entire mission was Tawheed
5. 'I was a witness over them while I was among them; when You took me up, You were the Watcher' (5:117) — He accepts no responsibility for what his followers did AFTER his departure

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Islamic Position on Christianity — With Love and Clarity

The Quran's presentation of Isa (AS)'s final testimony is not an attack on Christians — it is a defence of Isa (AS) himself. It shows that Isa (AS) will be the first to deny the claim of his own divinity. Scholars teach that Muslims honour Isa (AS) more than many understand: we believe in his virgin birth (without it being proof of divinity), his miracles, his noble character, his return before the Last Day. The difference is theology: Islam sees him as the penultimate Prophet — the one who announced the coming of Muhammad ﷺ (61:6). Engaging Christians with this understanding, with respect and love, is the Quranic way.

﴾ NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

The closing du'a of Isa (AS) in 5:118 is one of the most beautiful in the Quran: 'If You punish them, they are Your servants. And if You forgive them, You are the Almighty, the Wise.' This is the height of surrendered prayer — acknowledging Allah's absolute authority while trusting His wisdom and mercy. Make this your attitude in your own du'as: state your need, acknowledge Allah's right, and trust His infinite wisdom. This is Tawakkul in its purest form.

JUZ 4 & 5 — KEY LESSONS SUMMARY

Major Themes Covered in Juz 4 & 5 (Number of Verses Dedicated)

Women's Rights & Family	45	An-Nisa
Inheritance Law	15	An-Nisa
Justice & Adl	20	Both Surahs
Hypocrisy (Nifaq)	25	An-Nisa
Orphans' Rights	10	An-Nisa
Contracts & Covenants	12	Al-Ma'idah
Completion of Islam	5	Al-Ma'idah 5:3
Sanctity of Life	8	Al-Ma'idah 5:32
Food & Halal Laws	15	Al-Ma'idah
Isa (AS) & Inter-faith	30	Both Surahs

Golden Lesson	Surah & Verse	One-Line Summary
All humanity is one family	An-Nisa 4:1	From one soul — no race or tribe is superior
Protect the vulnerable — always	An-Nisa 4:2	Orphans, widows, the weak — they have RIGHTS, not charity
Justice even against yourself	An-Nisa 4:135	The hardest and highest character the Quran demands
Women have full spiritual equality	An-Nisa 4:124	Same faith, same deeds, same Paradise — same worth
Honour every contract you make	Al-Ma'idah 5:1	Your word is your Amanah — breaking it is sin
Islam is complete and perfect	Al-Ma'idah 5:3	Nothing to add, nothing to subtract — trust the whole
One life = all humanity	Al-Ma'idah 5:32	Take care of even one person — you save the world
Diversity is Allah's design	Al-Ma'idah 5:48	Race to goodness — don't race to uniformity
Halal food is body and soul	Al-Ma'idah 5:3,5:90	What you consume shapes your spiritual state
Isa (AS)'s testimony: Tawheed only	Al-Ma'idah 5:117	The greatest Prophet after Muhammad ﷺ worshipped Allah alone

Reflection Questions — Juz 4 & 5

Question	Verse	Action
Have I distributed inheritance in my family according to the Quran?	4:11-12	Make a will; learn the shares
Do I stand for justice even when it's against me?	4:135	In your next conflict — whose side is the truth really on?
Do I treat the women in my life with their full Quranic rights?	4:1, 4:124	Audit: Mahr paid? Rights given? Voice heard?
Do I fulfil all my contracts and promises?	5:1	List promises you have not yet kept — start with one
Am I 'racing to all that is good'?	5:48	Name one good deed you will do this week for humanity
How do I speak about other faiths?	5:48, 5:116	With knowledge, respect, and confidence — not dismissal



اَللّٰهُمَّ اِنِّیْ اَسْأَلُكَ عِلْمًا نَّافِعًا

Allahumma inni as'aluka 'ilman nafi'an
'O Allah, I ask You for beneficial knowledge.'
— Du'a of the Prophet ﷺ (Ibn Majah)

Volume IV — Juz 6 & 7: Surah Al-An'am & Al-A'raf

Creation • Prophets Ibrahim (AS), Nuh (AS), Lut (AS), Shu'ayb (AS) • The Bridge Between Worlds • The Heights

Compiled with love for the Ummah of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ
In the blessed tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Sallallahu alayhi wa aalihi wa sahbihi wa sallam